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2 Thessalonians - Introduction

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Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of 2 Thessalonians

1. Greetings and thanksgiving (1:1–2)
2. Believers suffer from persecution (1:3–12)

- God uses persecution to increase faith, love, and endurance in believers (1:3–4)
- God is just: (1:5–12)
- God will make believers worthy of his kingdom
- God will give relief to believers
- God will punish those who persecute believers

1. Some believers misunderstand about the second coming of Christ (2:1–12)

- Christ's return has not yet happened (2:1–2)
- Instruction about the events that will precede the return of Christ (2:3–12)

1. Paul's confidence that God will save the Thessalonian believers (2:13–17)

- Paul calls the Thessalonian believers to "stand firm" (2:13–15)
- Paul prays that God will comfort them (2:16–17)

1. Paul requests that the Thessalonian believers pray for him (3:1–5)
2. Paul give commands about idle believers (3:6–15)
3. Closing (3:16–17)

Who wrote 2 Thessalonians?
Paul wrote 2 Thessalonians. He was from the city of Tarsus. He had been known as Saul in his early life. Before becoming a Christian, Paul was a Pharisee. He persecuted believers. After he became a believer, he traveled several times throughout the Roman Empire telling people about Jesus.

Paul is the author of this letter, but he includes Silvanus and Timothy as senders of the letter. Paul wrote this letter while he, Silvanus, and Timothy were staying in the city of Corinth.

What is the book of 2 Thessalonians about?
Paul wrote this letter to the believers in the city of Thessalonica. He encouraged the believers because they were being persecuted. He told them to continue living in a way that pleased God. He also wanted to teach them again about Christ's return. He also warned them that they should not be idle but should work as they wait for Christ to return.

How should the title of this book be translated?
Translators may choose to call this book by its traditional title, "2 Thessalonians" or "Second Thessalonians." Or they may choose a clearer title, such as "Paul's Second Letter to the Church in Thessalonica," or "The Second Letter to the Christians/believers in Thessalonica." (See: How to Translate Names)

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

What is the "second coming" of Jesus?
Paul wrote much in this letter about Jesus' eventual return to Earth. When Jesus returns, he will judge all mankind. He will also rule over creation. And he will cause there to be peace everywhere. Paul also explained that a "man of lawlessness" will come before Christ's return. This person will obey Satan and cause many people to oppose God. But Jesus will destroy this person when he returns.

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

What did Paul mean by the expression "in Christ," "in the Lord," etc.?
Paul meant to express the idea of a very close union between Christ and the believers. Please see the introduction to the book of Romans for more details about this kind of expression.

How are pronouns used in this letter?
In this letter, the words "we" and "us" refer to Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy, unless otherwise noted. If your language differentiates between inclusive and exclusive pronouns, use an exclusive pronoun for these. (See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We')

In this letter, the words "you" and "your" are plural and refer to the Thessalonian believers. (See: Forms of 'You' — Singular)

What are the major issues in the text of the book of 2 Thessalonians?
For the following verses, some ancient manuscripts have a different reading than others. The ULT follows the reading that scholars consider to be the most accurate and puts the other reading in a footnote. If a translation of the Bible exists in your area that your people are familiar with, consider using the reading that it follows. If not, translators are advised to follow the reading in the ULT.

- "and the man of lawlessness is revealed" (2:3). The ULT, UST, and most modern versions read this way.

Other versions follow the reading, "and the man of sin is revealed."

- "For God chose you as the firstfruits for salvation" (2:13) The ULT, UST, and some other versions read this way. The other reading is, "For God chose you from the first/beginning for salvation."

(See: Textual Variants)

2 Thessalonians - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Verses 1–2 formally introduce this letter. Letters in the ancient Near East commonly had introductions of this type in which the sender identified himself, then the recipient, then gave a greeting.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Paradox

A paradox is a true statement that appears to describe something impossible.

A paradox occurs in verses 4–5 where Paul talks about the Thessalonian believers' faithfulness through persecution as "evidence of the righteous judgment of God." People would not normally think that believing in God while being persecuted is a sign of God's righteous judgment. But the fact that God gave them the ability to persevere in their faith is evidence that God claims them as his own and will judge them as worthy of his kingdom. In verses 5–10, Paul goes on to explain more of God's righteous judgment, that God will reward those who believe in him and that he will punish those who afflict his people. (2 Thessalonians 1:4–5)

Another paradox occurs in verse 9 where Paul describes the penalty for rejecting God as "eternal destruction." Normally when something is destroyed it ceases to exist. But in this case, the people who reject God will experience eternal separation from God, as the verse goes on to explain. Being separated from God destroys all that was enjoyable about their lives, and this continuous destruction is what they experience through eternity. (2 Thessalonians 1:9)

2 Thessalonians 1:1 (#1)

Σιλουανὸς

"Silvanus"

Silvanus is the Latin form of "Silas." **Silvanus** is the name of a man, the same person listed in the book of Acts as Paul's fellow traveler. If your readers may not know that these two are the same person, you could use the name "Silas" in the text and "Silvanus" in the footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

2 Thessalonians 1:1 (#2)

Παῦλος, καὶ Σιλουανὸς, καὶ Τιμόθεος; τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

"Paul and Silvanus and Timothy, to the church"

You may want to fill in the words necessary to make this a complete sentence. Alternate translation: [Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy send this letter to the church]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 1:1 (#3)

Παῦλος, καὶ Σιλουανὸς, καὶ Τιμόθεος

"Paul and Silvanus and Timothy"

Although **Paul** wrote this letter, he identifies **Silvanus and Timothy** as also sending it. This means that they were with him and were in agreement with it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make that clear, as in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:1 (#4)

ἐν Θεῷ Πατρὶ ἡμῶν καὶ Κυρίῳ Ἰησοῦ Χριστῷ

"in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ"

Here Paul speaks of the believers as though they were occupying space inside of God and Jesus. This metaphor expresses the idea that believers are spiritually united to God and Jesus. If this might be misunderstood in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [united to God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ] or [sharing life with God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 1:2 (#1)

χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη ἀπὸ Θεοῦ Πατρὸς καὶ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"Grace to you and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ"

Many languages have different ways to offer good wishes as they greet. Paul greeted his letter recipients with a blessing. Use a form that would be a good wish or blessing in your language. Alternate translation: [We pray that God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ give you grace and peace] or [I wish you grace and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ]

or [May the grace and peace of God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ be your portion] or [May God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ show grace and give peace to your hearts]

See: Blessings

2 Thessalonians 1:2 (#2)

χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη ἀπὸ Θεοῦ Πατρὸς καὶ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"Grace to you and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas behind **Grace** and **peace**, you can express these ideas as verbs or in another way. Alternate translation: [May God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ be gracious to you and give rest to your inner being] or [be favorable to you and make you at ease] or [be kind to you and set your heart at rest]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#5)

ἀδελφοί

"brothers"

Here, **brothers** means fellow Christians, including both men and women. If your readers understand that it is addressed only to men, you may need to use both the masculine and the feminine forms of that word in your language. If you use a nonfigurative word such as "believers", see that both the genders are addressed. Alternate translation: [brothers and sisters]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#2)

εὐχαριστεῖν ὀφείλομεν & πάντοτε

"We ought always to give thanks"

Paul here uses the word **ought** to express that he has a moral obligation to God to **give thanks** for the believers in Thessalonica. Use a natural expression for this in your language. Alternate translation: [We are bound always to thank] or [We can do no other than to thank] or [We must give thanks continually to]

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#7)

ὑπεραυξάνει ἡ πίστις ὑμῶν

"your faith is increasing greatly"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind **faith**, you can express this idea as a verb. Alternate translation: [you believe in Christ more and more] or [you increasingly trust in Christ] or [you rely on Christ more each day]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#3)

εὐχαριστεῖν ὀφείλομεν τῷ Θεῷ πάντοτε

"We ought always to give thanks to God"

Paul uses **always** as a generalization meaning "often" or "regularly." Alternate translation: [We should often give thanks to God]

See: Hyperbole

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#4)

εὐχαριστεῖν ὀφείλομεν τῷ Θεῷ πάντοτε περὶ ὑμῶν, ἀδελφοί

"We ought always to give thanks to God for you, brothers"

If your readers might think that Paul is expressing an obligation only and that he does not actually pray for the Thessalonians, you could express the reality explicitly. Alternate translation: [We always thank God for you, brothers, as we ought]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#9)

ἀλλήλους

"one another"

Here, **one another** means fellow believers. Alternate translation: [each other] or [each believer]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#6)

καθὼς ἄξιόν ἐστιν

"just as it is fitting"

If it is difficult to express **just as it is fitting** in your language or if it is unclear what **it** refers to, consider starting a new sentence here to state it clearly. Alternate translation: [When we give thanks for you we are doing the right thing] or [Giving thanks for you is right for us to be doing] or [is the right thing to do]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#8)

πλεονάζει ἡ ἀγάπη ἑνὸς ἑκάστου, πάντων ὑμῶν, εἰς ἀλλήλους

“the love of each one of you all for one another is increasing”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind **love**, you can express this idea as a verb. Alternate translation: [each of you sincerely loves one another more and more]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:3 (#1)

In verses 3–12, Paul gives thanks for the believers in Thessalonica and prays for them. A heading for this section might be, “Thanks and Prayers.”

See: Section Headings

2 Thessalonians 1:4 (#1)

αὐτοὺς ἡμᾶς

“we ourselves”

Here, **ourselves** is added to **we** to emphasize that even the apostle Paul and his associates are boasting about the Thessalonian believers. Alternate translation: [even we] or [we are the ones who]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

2 Thessalonians 1:4 (#2)

τῆς ὑπομονῆς ὑμῶν, καὶ πίστεως

“your endurance and faith”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **endurance** and **faith** or if it is unclear how these two terms relate, you can express these same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [how you patiently continue to trust in Jesus] or [how you persevere in believing in the Lord]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:4 (#3)

ἐν πᾶσιν τοῖς διωγμοῖς ὑμῶν, καὶ ταῖς θλίψεσιν

“in all your persecutions and afflictions”

The two words **persecutions** and **afflictions** are saying very similar things. The repetition is used to emphasize how difficult life has been for the Thessalonian believers. If two words are difficult to find in your language or if your language does not use repetition in this way, you can use one word with this meaning and make the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [as you have been going through all these very difficult times] or [as people make you suffer in all the ways]

See: Doublet

2 Thessalonians 1:4 (#4)

πίστεως ἐν πᾶσιν τοῖς διωγμοῖς ὑμῶν

“faith in all your persecutions”

Here, **faith in all your persecutions** does not mean to believe in or trust in persecutions. If your readers might be confused by that, you could express it more clearly. Alternate translation: [faith in Jesus Christ during all the times you are persecuted]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:5 (#1)

ἔνδειγμα τῆς δικαίας κρίσεως τοῦ Θεοῦ, εἰς τὸ καταξιωθῆναι ὑμᾶς

“evidence of the righteous judgment of God, for you to be considered worthy”

The **evidence** that Paul is referring to here is the faithful endurance of the Thessalonian believers while suffering persecution, which he mentioned in verse 4. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. It may also be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Your endurance while suffering is a clear indication of God’s righteous judgment, that he considers you worthy] or [Your faithfulness through persecution shows that God is just and right to consider you worthy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:5 (#3)

ὑπὲρ ἧς καὶ πάσχετε

“for which you also suffer”

Here, **also** could mean: (1) the Thessalonian believers are suffering for the kingdom of God as well as being counted worthy of it. Alternate translation: [being a part of which is also the reason that you are suffering]; (2) the Thessalonian believers are suffering along with other believers. Alternate translation: [which is why you are going through sufferings along with many others]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:5 (#2)

εἰς τὸ καταξιωθῆναι ὑμᾶς τῆς Βασιλείας τοῦ Θεοῦ

“for you to be considered worthy of the kingdom of God”

You can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [that God will consider you worthy to be part of his kingdom]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 1:6 (#2)

παρὰ Θεῷ, ἀνταποδοῦναι τοῖς θλίβουσιν ὑμᾶς θλῖψιν

"for God to return affliction to the ones afflicting you"

Here, **to return** means to cause someone to experience the same thing that they did to someone else as though the same action were bouncing back onto the people who did that action. Use a natural expression for this kind of reciprocal action. Alternate translation: [for God to afflict those who are afflicting you] or [for God to pay back those who are afflicting you] or [for God to do the same to those who are afflicting you]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 1:6 (#3)

ἀνταποδοῦναι τοῖς θλίβουσιν ὑμᾶς θλῖψιν

"to return affliction to the ones afflicting you"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **affliction**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to afflict those who are afflicting you] or [to trouble those who are troubling you]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:6 (#1)

εἴπερ δίκαιον παρὰ Θεῷ

"if indeed {it is} righteous for God"

Paul is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, and if your readers might think that what Paul is saying is not certain, then you could translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [Since you know that God is just] or [for God is certainly right]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

2 Thessalonians 1:7 (#1)

καὶ ὑμῖν & ἄνεσιν

"and relief to you"

The words **and relief to you** continue the description of what God is right "to return" to people (verse 6). If this would not be understood in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [and it is righteous for God to give relief to you]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 1:7 (#3)

ὑμῖν & ἄνεσιν

"relief to you"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind **relief**, you can express this idea with a verb or in another way. Alternate translation: [to relieve you] or [to rescue you]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:7 (#5)

ἐν τῇ ἀποκαλύψει τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

"at the revealing of the Lord Jesus"

Here, **at the revealing** is an indication of the time when the suffering believers will have relief from their suffering. Alternate translation: [at the time when the Lord Jesus is revealed] or [when everyone sees the Lord Jesus coming]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:7 (#2)

καὶ ὑμῖν τοῖς θλιβομένοις, ἄνεσιν μεθ' ἡμῶν

"and relief to you, the ones being afflicted with us"

Here, **you who are being afflicted** refers to the Thessalonian believers, and **us** refers to Paul and his associates. Other people are afflicting both groups because of their faith in Jesus. Alternate translation: [and relief to you who are being afflicted just as we are being afflicted]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Thessalonians 1:7 (#4)

τοῖς θλιβομένοις

"the ones being afflicted"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom other people are afflicting] or [from the affliction that others are causing you]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 1:8 (#1)

διδόντος ἐκδίκησιν τοῖς

“taking vengeance on the ones”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind **vengeance**, you can express this idea in another way. Since this is part of God’s justice, do not use a word that implies that God is doing something illegal or inappropriate. Alternate translation: [punishing the people] or [judging the ones]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:8 (#5)

τῷ εὐαγγελίῳ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ

“the gospel of our Lord Jesus”

Here, Paul is using the general possessive form **of our Lord Jesus** to describe **the gospel**. The specific meaning here is that the gospel is about Jesus. Alternate translation: [the gospel that is about our Lord Jesus] or [the gospel message that tells us about our Lord Jesus]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 1:8 (#2)

τοῖς μὴ εἰδόσι Θεὸν

“on the ones not having known God”

Here, **the ones not having known God** refers to those who have refused the relationship with God that he had offered to them. Alternate translation: [on those who did not want to know God] or [on those who have rejected God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:8 (#3)

καὶ τοῖς μὴ ὑπακούουσιν τῷ εὐαγγελίῳ

“and on the ones not obeying the gospel”

The phrase, **not obeying the gospel** could refer to: (1) the same people as **those not having known God**. Alternate translation: [and who are not obeying the gospel]; (2) a separate group. Alternate translation: [and also on those who are not obeying the gospel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:8 (#4)

ὑπακούουσιν τῷ εὐαγγελίῳ

“obeying the gospel”

The phrase, **obeying the gospel** is an idiom that means to live according to everything that God tells us in the gospel message. Alternate translation: [living according to the message of the gospel] or [heeding the admonitions that are part of the gospel message]

See: Idiom

2 Thessalonians 1:9 (#6)

τῆς δόξης τῆς ἰσχύος αὐτοῦ

“the glory of his power”

Here, the possessive form is describing **power** that has **glory**. If this is not clear in your language, you could use the adjective “glorious” to describe the **power**. Alternate translation: [his glorious power]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 1:9 (#1)

οἵτινες δίκην τίσουσιν

“who will pay the penalty”

Here, **who** refers to the people who are not obeying the gospel, not to the Lord Jesus. You may prefer to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Those people will pay the penalty]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Thessalonians 1:9 (#3)

δίκην τίσουσιν

“will pay the penalty”

Here, the phrase **pay the penalty** is an idiom meaning to suffer the consequences of doing something bad. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [will suffer the consequences] or [will undergo the retribution]

See: Idiom

2 Thessalonians 1:9 (#2)

οἵτινες δίκην τίσουσιν

“who will pay the penalty”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of the word **penalty**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [who will be punished by God] or [whom God will punish]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:9 (#5)

ἀπὸ προσώπου τοῦ Κυρίου

“away from the face of the Lord”

Here, **the face of the Lord** is an idiom meaning the presence of the Lord. Alternate translation: [away from our Lord Jesus] or [separated from the presence of the Lord Jesus]

See: Idiom

2 Thessalonians 1:9 (#7)

τῆς δόξης τῆς ἰσχύος αὐτοῦ

“the glory of his power”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas of **glory** and **power**, you can express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [experiencing how magnificent and powerful he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:9 (#4)

ὄλεθρον αἰώνιον

“eternal destruction”

Here, **eternal destruction** further describes the **penalty** that people will experience if they refuse to “obey the gospel.” The **destruction** that these people will experience is **eternal**, that is, it never ends. Therefore, do not translate with the meaning that these people will cease to exist. They will continue to exist, but continually experience the ruin of their lives. If necessary, put this information in a footnote. Alternate translation: [God will punish them eternally]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:10 (#1)

ὅταν ἔλθῃ & ἐν τῇ ἡμέρᾳ ἐκείνῃ

“when he comes on that day”

Here, **that day** is the day when Jesus will return to the world. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express that explicitly. Alternate translation: [on the day when Jesus returns to the world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:10 (#2)

ἐνδοξασθῆναι ἐν τοῖς ἁγίοις αὐτοῦ, καὶ θαυμασθῆναι ἐν πᾶσιν τοῖς πιστεύσασιν

“to be glorified by his saints and to be marveled at by all the ones having believed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as his saints glorify him and all those who have believed marvel at him]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 1:10 (#5)

ἐπιστεύθη τὸ μαρτύριον ἡμῶν ἐφ’ ὑμᾶς

“our testimony to you has been believed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you have believed our witness when we shared it with you] or [when we testified about the saving power of Jesus Christ, you believed what we said]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 1:10 (#4)

ἐνδοξασθῆναι ἐν τοῖς ἁγίοις αὐτοῦ, καὶ θαυμασθῆναι ἐν πᾶσιν τοῖς πιστεύσασιν

“to be glorified by his saints and to be marveled at by all the ones having believed”

The **saints** and **the ones having believed** are one group of people, not two. If your readers might be confused by this, you could combine these into one phrase. Alternate translation: [with the result that all of his saints, that is, the believers, will glorify him and marvel at him] or [as all of his people glorify him and marvel at him]

2 Thessalonians 1:10 (#3)

ἐνδοξασθῆναι ἐν τοῖς ἁγίοις αὐτοῦ, καὶ θαυμασθῆναι

“to be glorified by his saints and to be marveled at”

Here, the two verbs **to be glorified** and **to be marveled at** indicate the result of Jesus’ coming, not the purpose. Use a connector here that indicates result. Alternate translation: [as his saints glorify him and all those who have believed marvel at him] or [with the result that his saints will glorify him and all those who have believed will marvel at him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Thessalonians 1:11 (#3)

τῆς κλήσεως

“of the calling”

Here, **calling** refers to God appointing or choosing people to belong to him and to proclaim his message of salvation through Jesus. Alternate translation: [to appoint you to belong to him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 1:11 (#1)

εἰς ὃ

"For this"

Here, **For this** connects verse 11 to verse 10, so that verse 11 gives the means or method (prayer for the Thessalonian believers) for reaching the purpose that verse 10 has just described (for Jesus to "be glorified ... and marveled at"). Use a natural way in your language for introducing this relationship. Alternate translation: [This is why] or [To this end]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

2 Thessalonians 1:11 (#5)

καὶ πληρώσῃ

"and he may fulfill"

Here, **and he may fulfill** adds another reason why Paul and his associates **pray always** for the Thessalonian believers. This part of the sentence assumes some of the words from earlier in the sentence. If this would be misunderstood in your language, you could supply these words from the earlier part of the sentence. Alternate translation: [and we also pray so that he may fulfill]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 1:11 (#4)

πληρώσῃ πᾶσαν εὐδοκίαν ἀγαθωσύνης, καὶ ἔργον πίστεως ἐν δυνάμει

"he may fulfill every desire of goodness and work of faith in power"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas behind **desire**, **goodness**, **faith**, and **power**, you can express these ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [he may make you able to do all of the good things that you want to do because you trust in Jesus and because God is powerful] or [he may empower you to act on what you believe in order to do good things in every way that you desire, because God is powerful]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:11 (#2)

καὶ προσευχόμεθα πάντοτε περὶ ὑμῶν

"we also pray always for you"

Paul is using **always** as an exaggeration in order to emphasize how often he prays for them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language. Alternate translation: [we also pray regularly for you] or [we continue to pray for you]

See: Hyperbole

2 Thessalonians 1:12 (#1)

ὅπως

"so that"

Here, **so that** introduces the purpose for which Paul and his associates pray all of the things mentioned in verse 11. It is a repetition of the same purpose that was given in verse 10, using similar words. Alternate translation: [and we also pray so that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

2 Thessalonians 1:12 (#6)

κατὰ τὴν χάριν τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν

"according to the grace of our God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [according to how exceedingly kind our God and the Lord Jesus Christ are to you] or [as our God and the Lord Jesus Christ continue to abundantly bless you]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 1:12 (#7)

τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν καὶ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"of our God and the Lord Jesus Christ"

The phrase translated as **our God and the Lord Jesus Christ** could refer to: (1) two persons of the Trinity, God the Father and Jesus the Son. (2) one person, Jesus, who is both God and Lord. Alternate translation: [of our God and Lord, Jesus Christ]

2 Thessalonians 1:12 (#3)

ὅπως ἐνδοξασθῇ τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ, ἐν ὑμῖν

"so that the name of our Lord Jesus might be glorified in you"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. This could mean: (1) the Thessalonian believers will glorify Jesus. Alternate translation: [so that you would glorify the name of our Lord Jesus]; (2) others will glorify Jesus because of what he has done for the Thessalonian believers. Alternate translation: [so that people would glorify the name of our Lord Jesus because of you]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 1:12 (#5)

καὶ ὑμεῖς ἐν αὐτῷ

"and you in him"

The phrase **and you in him** leaves out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If this would be misunderstood in your language, you could make a complete sentence by supplying these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and so that you might be glorified in him] or [and so that he might glorify you]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 1:12 (#4)

καὶ ὑμεῖς ἐν αὐτῷ

"and you in him"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Jesus might glorify you]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 1:12 (#2)

τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ

"the name of our Lord Jesus"

Here, **the name of our Lord Jesus** stands for the person of the Lord Jesus. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the reputation of our Lord Jesus] or [our Lord Jesus]

See: Metonymy

2 Thessalonians - Chapter 2 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Man of lawlessness
This person is also called "the son of destruction" and "the lawless one" in this chapter. He is not Satan, but he is empowered by Satan and is the leader of those who do Satan's evil work in the world in the last days. He is certainly one of the "antichrists" mentioned by John (1 John 2:18) and may be the final one, described as a beast in Revelation 13. (See: antichrist)

Sits in the temple of God
Paul could be referring to the Jerusalem temple that the Romans destroyed several years after he wrote this letter. Or he could be referring to a future physical temple, or to the church as the spiritual temple of God. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

2 Thessalonians 2:1 (#3)

ὑπὲρ τῆς παρουσίας τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, καὶ ἡμῶν ἐπισυναγωγῆς ἐπ' αὐτόν

"about the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ and our gathering to him"

The **coming of our Lord Jesus Christ** and **our gathering to him** are two actions that happen at the same time. You can make this clear in your translation with an appropriate connecting word or phrase. Alternate translation: [regarding the time of our Lord Jesus coming when we will be gathered together unto him]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:1 (#5)

ἀδελφοί

"brothers"

Here, **brothers** means fellow Christians, including both men and women. Alternate translation: [brothers and sisters]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 2:1 (#2)

δὲ

"Now"

The word translated **Now** marks a change in topic. You can use a natural way in your language to show that this is a new section with a different topic than the previous section.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Thessalonians 2:1 (#4)

ὑπὲρ τῆς παρουσίας τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, καὶ ἡμῶν ἐπισυναγωγῆς ἐπ' αὐτόν

"about the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ and our gathering to him"

If it is more natural in your language, you could use active verbs for the events of **coming** and **gathering**. Alternate translation: [about the time when our Lord Jesus will come and gather us to himself]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:1 (#1)

In verses 1–12, Paul exhorts believers not to be deceived about the day Jesus will come back and warns them about the coming man of lawlessness. A heading for this section might be, "The Man of Lawlessness" or "The Deception before Jesus Returns."

See: Section Headings

2 Thessalonians 2:2 (#6)

ἡ ἡμέρα τοῦ Κυρίου

"the day of the Lord"

Here, **the day of the Lord** refers to the time when Jesus will come back to the earth for all believers.

2 Thessalonians 2:2 (#5)

ὡς

"as if"

Paul is leaving out some words here that might be necessary in your language. If it is helpful, you could supply these words. Alternate translation: [that talks as if] or [that falsely claims that]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 2:2 (#4)

ὡς δι' ἡμῶν

"as if from us"

Paul is leaving out some words here that might be necessary in your language. If it is helpful, you could supply these words. Alternate translation: [that claims to have come from us] or [trying to deceive you that it is from us]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 2:2 (#1)

εἰς τὸ μὴ ταχέως σαλευθῆναι ὑμᾶς ἀπὸ τοῦ νοὸς

"for you not to be quickly shaken in your mind"

The phrase **shaken in your mind** refers to a person's thoughts being unsettled. You could also express this positively. Alternate translation: [for you to remain firm in your thinking]

See: Double Negatives

2 Thessalonians 2:2 (#3)

μήτε διὰ πνεύματος, μήτε διὰ λόγου, μήτε δι' ἐπιστολῆς, ὡς δι' ἡμῶν

"neither by a spirit nor by a word nor by a letter as if from us"

Paul is leaving out some words here that might be necessary in your language. If it is helpful, you could supply these words. Alternate translation: [when you receive a message either by means of a spirit or by means of a spoken word or by means of a written letter that pretends to be coming from us]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 2:2 (#2)

μηδὲ θροεῖσθαι

"and not to be troubled"

The phrase **to be troubled** refers to a person's emotions being unsettled. You could also express this positively. Alternate translation: [and remain peaceful when a message comes] or [and keep calm when you hear something]

See: Double Negatives

2 Thessalonians 2:3 (#7)

ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας

"the son of destruction"

God will destroy this person some time after the events of verse 4. If it would be helpful in your language, consider moving this phrase to the end of verse 4.

See: Order of Events

2 Thessalonians 2:3 (#5)

ὁ ἄνθρωπος τῆς ἀνομίας

"the man of lawlessness"

Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **man** who is characterized by **lawlessness**. By this Paul means that this man will oppose all of God's commandments and instructions. If this is not clear in your language, you could express this another way. Alternate translation: [the lawless man] or [the man who opposes God's rule]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 2:3 (#6)

ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας

“the son of destruction”

Here, **son of destruction** is an idiom meaning a person who is destined for destruction. Alternate translation: [the one who will be destroyed] or [the one whom God will destroy]

See: Idiom

2 Thessalonians 2:3 (#4)

ἀποκαλυφθῇ ὁ ἄνθρωπος τῆς ἀνομίας

“the man of lawlessness is revealed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the man of lawlessness arrives] or [the man of lawlessness makes himself known]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:3 (#1)

μή τις ὑμᾶς ἐξαπατήσῃ κατὰ μηδένα τρόπον

“May no one deceive you in any way”

Alternate translation: [Do not permit anyone to fool you] or [Do not believe at all the wrong words that people are telling you about this]

2 Thessalonians 2:3 (#3)

ἡ ἀποστασία

“the apostasy”

Here, **the apostasy** refers to a future time when many people will turn away from God. If your language does not use an abstract noun for this idea, you can express it in another way. Alternate translation: [the time when many people will rebel against God]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:3 (#2)

ὅτι ἐὰν μὴ ἔλθῃ ἡ ἀποστασία πρῶτον

“for unless the apostasy comes first”

Here, Paul is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the previous verse. Alternate translation: [for the day of the Lord will not come unless the apostasy comes first]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 2:4 (#3)

ἀποδεικνύντα ἑαυτὸν ὅτι ἔστιν Θεός

“showing that he himself is God”

Here, **showing that he himself is God** does not mean that this man is God, but only that he is displaying himself to the world as though he were God. Alternate translation: [showing himself as God] or [attempting to demonstrate to people that he himself is God]

2 Thessalonians 2:4 (#2)

αὐτὸν & καθίσαι

“he himself sits”

Here, **he himself sits** is part of a description of the kinds of things that this person does. If it is confusing in your language to use the present tense for this, you could use the future tense, since this will happen in the future. Alternate translation: [he himself will sit]

See: Predictive Past

2 Thessalonians 2:4 (#1)

πάντα λεγόμενον θεὸν ἢ σέβασμα

“everything being called god or an object of worship”

You can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [everything that people call God or whatever they worship]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:5 (#1)

οὐ μνημονεύετε ὅτι, ἔτι ὢν πρὸς ὑμᾶς, ταῦτα ἔλεγον ὑμῖν

“Do you not remember that, still being with you, I was telling you these things”

Paul is not asking for information here, but is using the question form to remind the Thessalonians of what he taught when he was with them previously. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement. See the UST.

See: Rhetorical Question

2 Thessalonians 2:5 (#2)

ταῦτα

“these things”

Here, **these things** refers to the topics that Paul mentioned in verses 3 and 4, including the rebellion against God, the man of lawlessness, and the return of Jesus on the day of the Lord.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Thessalonians 2:6 (#2)

τὸ ἀποκαλυφθῆναι αὐτὸν ἐν τῷ αὐτοῦ καιρῷ

"his revealing in his time"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the proper time, when God will allow him to reveal himself]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:6 (#1)

καὶ νῦν τὸ κατέχον οἴδατε

"And now you know the one restraining {him"

There are two possibilities for understanding the function of the word **now** here. (1) It goes with **the one restraining {him}**. Alternate translation: [And you know what is restraining him now] or (2) it goes with **you know**. Alternate translation: [And now you know what is restraining him]

2 Thessalonians 2:7 (#5)

ἐκ μέσου γένηται

"he comes out of the way"

Here Paul speaks of the person who is restraining the man of lawlessness as though he were standing in front of him and blocking his path. If this does not make sense in your language, you could use an equivalent metaphor or you could express the meaning in a nonfigurative way. Alternate translation: [he stops restraining him]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 2:7 (#4)

γένηται

"he comes"

Here, **he** refers to the one who is restraining the man of lawlessness. If this is not clear to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [the one who restrains the man of lawlessness moves]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Thessalonians 2:7 (#2)

τὸ & μυστήριον ἤδη ἐνεργεῖται τῆς ἀνομίας

"the mystery of lawlessness is already working"

Here, **lawlessness** is characterized as a **mystery** because we cannot understand why people rebel against God's wise instructions unless we understand the spiritual forces at work, which Paul explains here. If your language does not use abstract nouns for these ideas, you can express them in another way. Alternate translation: [people are already mysteriously rebelling against God] or [Satan is already secretly leading people to reject God's laws, as this man will do]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:7 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Here, the word translated **For** serves to connect this sentence as a contrast to what Paul has said about **lawlessness**, starting in verse 3. Until here, Paul was talking about lawlessness in the future, but now he wants to clarify that people are already being lawless. Use a natural way in your language for introducing this contrast. Alternate translation: [Now] or [Actually,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:7 (#3)

ὁ κατέχων

"the one restraining {him"

To restrain someone is to hold him back or to keep him from doing what he wants to do. Alternate translation: [the one who has been holding him back]

2 Thessalonians 2:8 (#3)

ἀνελεῖ τῷ πνεύματι τοῦ στόματος αὐτοῦ, καὶ καταργήσει τῇ ἐπιφανείᾳ τῆς παρουσίας αὐτοῦ

"will kill with the breath of his mouth, and will bring to nothing by the appearance of his coming"

These two phrases describe the same event. Paul says the same thing twice, in slightly different ways, to emphasize how much more powerful Jesus is than the man of lawlessness. If it is confusing for your readers to talk about killing someone and then bringing him to nothing, you could reverse the order of the phrases, as in the UST, or you can combine the phrases into one. Alternate translation: [will destroy by his glorious appearance and with the breath of his mouth]

See: Parallelism

2 Thessalonians 2:8 (#2)

τῷ πνεύματι τοῦ στόματος αὐτοῦ

“with the breath of his mouth”

In this figure of speech, **breath** represents the power of God and **mouth** represents the spoken word of Jesus. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by the power of his spoken word]

See: Metonymy

2 Thessalonians 2:8 (#1)

καὶ τότε ἀποκαλυφθήσεται ὁ ἄνομος

“and then the lawless one will be revealed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and then God will allow the lawless one to show himself]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:9 (#3)

ἐν πάσῃ δυνάμει, καὶ σημείοις, καὶ τέρασιν ψεύδους

“in all power and signs and false wonders”

Here, **all** is hyperbole. It can apply to: (1) only **power**, with the meaning “much” or “great.” Alternate translation: [with great power to do signs and false wonders] or (2) **power**, **signs**, and **wonders**, with the meaning [many kinds of.] Alternate translation: [with many kinds of power, signs, and false wonders] or (3) a combination of the two. Alternate translation: [with much power to do all kinds of signs and false wonders]

See: Hyperbole

2 Thessalonians 2:9 (#1)

οὗ ἐστιν ἡ παρουσία, κατ’ ἐνέργειαν τοῦ Σατανᾶ

“the arrival of whom is according to a work of Satan”

Here, Paul is using the possessive form to describe **work** that **Satan** does. If this is not clear in your language, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [Satan will bring this man and will work through him]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 2:9 (#5)

καὶ σημείοις, καὶ τέρασιν ψεύδους

“and signs and false wonders”

The words **signs** and **wonders** often occur together and mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize how amazing they are. If your language does not have two words for this or does not use repetition to do this, you can use one word and provide emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and amazing false miracles]

See: Doublet

2 Thessalonians 2:9 (#4)

ἐν πάσῃ δυνάμει, καὶ σημείοις, καὶ τέρασιν ψεύδους

“in all power and signs and false wonders”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **power**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [with very powerful signs and false wonders] or [who made him very powerful to do signs and false wonders]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:9 (#2)

οὗ

“of whom”

Here, **whom** refers back to the man of lawlessness. Alternate translation: [of the man of lawlessness]

2 Thessalonians 2:10 (#2)

ἐν πάσῃ ἀπάτῃ ἀδικίας

“in all deceit of unrighteousness”

Here Paul uses the possessive form to describe **deceit** that results from **unrighteousness**. If the relationship of the words is not clear in your language, you could express it more explicitly. Alternate translation: [because he is so unrighteous, he will be very deceptive]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 2:10 (#1)

πάσῃ

“all”

Here, **all** is hyperbole and could mean: (1) “a high degree of” or (2) “many kinds of”

See: Hyperbole

2 Thessalonians 2:10 (#3)

ἐν πάσῃ ἀπάτῃ ἀδικίας, τοῖς ἀπολλυμένοις

"in all deceit of unrighteousness to the ones perishing"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **deceit** and **unrighteousness**, you can express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [because he is so unrighteous, he will completely deceive those who are perishing]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:10 (#7)

εἰς τὸ σωθῆναι αὐτούς

"for them to be saved"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who does the action, that would be God. Alternate translation: [for God to save them] or [so that God would save them]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:10 (#5)

τὴν ἀγάπην τῆς ἀληθείας οὐκ ἐδέξαντο

"they did not receive the love of the truth"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **love** and **truth**, you can express the same ideas in another way. Also, your language might prefer an expression other than **love** for something as impersonal as **truth**. Alternate translation: [they did not want to consider the true message about Jesus to be important]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:10 (#4)

ἀνθ' ὧν

"because of which"

What follows this phrase is the reason that the people are perishing. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a reason. You may want to start a new sentence here and end what came before it with a period. Alternate translation: [They are perishing because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:10 (#6)

εἰς τὸ σωθῆναι αὐτούς

"for them to be saved"

This phrase could express: (1) the result of receiving the love of the truth. Alternate translation: [and thus be saved] or (2) the purpose of loving the truth. Alternate translation: [so that they could be saved]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:11 (#5)

εἰς τὸ πιστεῦσαι αὐτοὺς

"for them to believe"

Here, **them** refers to the people who "did not receive the love of the truth" in verse 10. If this might confuse your readers, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [so that these people may believe] or [in order that the people who did not receive the love of the truth may believe]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Thessalonians 2:11 (#3)

ἐνέργειαν πλάνης

"a working of error"

Paul is using the possessive form to describe a **working** that is characterized by **error**. This means something that works to produce error in them. Alternate translation: [the ability to think in a wrong way]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 2:11 (#4)

εἰς τὸ πιστεῦσαι αὐτοὺς

"for them to believe"

Here, **for** introduces a purpose clause. Paul is stating the purpose for which God sends the **working of error**. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a purpose clause. Alternate translation: [so that they may believe]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:11 (#2)

πέμπει αὐτοῖς ὁ Θεὸς ἐνέργειαν πλάνης, εἰς τὸ πιστεῦσαι αὐτοὺς τῷ ψεύδει

"God is sending to them a working of error for them to believe the lie"

Paul is speaking of **God** allowing something to happen to people as if he is **sending** something to them. Alternate translation: [God is allowing them to think

wrongly so that they believe the lies of the man of lawlessness]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 2:11 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο

"because of this"

What follows **because of this** is the result of the action of the people who "did not receive the love of the truth" in verse 10. Use a connector that shows that what the people did in verse 10 is the reason for what follows in this verse. Alternate translation: [for this reason] or [because the people did not receive the love of the truth]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:12 (#4)

οἱ μὴ πιστεύσαντες τῇ ἀληθείᾳ, ἀλλὰ εὐδοκήσαντες τῇ ἀδικίᾳ

"the ones not having believed the truth, but having taken pleasure in the unrighteousness"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **truth** and **unrighteousness**, you can express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [those who have not believed the true message but have enjoyed doing sinful things] or [those people who have rejected the true message about the Lord and instead have chosen to do what is wrong]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:12 (#3)

οἱ

"the ones"

Here, **the ones** refers back to the people that Paul has described with similar terms in verse 10. These are the same people who "did not receive the love of the truth" and instead accepted the "deceit of unrighteousness." You may want to start a new sentence here and end what came before with a period. Alternate translation: [Those are the people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

2 Thessalonians 2:12 (#2)

κριθῶσιν πάντες

"they might all be judged"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, that would be God. Alternate translation: [God may judge all of them]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:12 (#1)

ἵνα

"so that"

This phrase introduces a purpose clause. This follows the purpose clause of verse 11, so you may want to link them together. Alternate translation: [and furthermore, so that] or [and therefore]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#6)

ἀδελφοὶ

"brothers"

Here, **brothers** means fellow Christians, including both men and women. If your readers understand that it is addressed only to men, you may need to use both the masculine and the feminine forms of that word in your language. If you use a nonfigurative word such as "believers", see that both the genders are addressed. Alternate translation: [brothers and sisters]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#2)

δὲ

"Now"

The word translated **Now** marks a change in topic. You can use a natural way in your language to indicate/show that this is a new section with a different topic than the previous section.

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#4)

ἡμεῖς & ὀφείλομεν

"we ought"

Here, **we** refers to three men, Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy. If you have exclusive and inclusive first-person pronouns in your language, this should be an exclusive pronoun.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#8)

ἀπαρχὴν εἰς σωτηρίαν ἐν ἁγιασμῷ Πνεύματος καὶ πίστει ἀληθείας

“as} firstfruits for salvation in sanctification of the Spirit and belief in the truth”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could change the abstract nouns **salvation**, **sanctification**, **belief**, and **truth** into verbal forms. Alternate translation: [to be among the first people who believe what is true, and whom God has saved and set apart for himself by his Spirit]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#3)

ἡμεῖς & ὀφείλομεν εὐχαριστεῖν & πάντοτε

“we ought always to give thanks”

The word **always** is a generalization. This is used to emphasize the importance of the action. If this is not natural in your language, you could use the alternative renderings given. Alternate translation: [we should continually give thanks] or [we must thank God at all times]

See: Hyperbole

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#1)

Paul now changes topics. If you are using section headings, you could put one here before verse 13. Suggested heading: “Paul gives thanks to God for the believers and encourages them.”

See: Section Headings

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#7)

ἀπαρχὴν εἰς σωτηρίαν

“as} firstfruits for salvation”

Being among the first people to be saved is spoken of as if the Thessalonian believers were **firstfruits**. Alternate translation: [to be among the first people who believe] or [to be some of the first people whom God was saving]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 2:13 (#5)

ἀδελφοὶ ἠγαπημένοι ὑπὸ Κυρίου

“brothers having been loved by the Lord”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can say this with an active form. Alternate translation: [for the Lord loves you, brothers]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:14 (#2)

εἰς περιποίησιν δόξης τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“to the acquiring of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ”

The phrase **to the acquiring of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ** does not mean that we will take over or divide up the glory of Jesus Christ. It means that the believers will share in Christ’s glory. Alternate translation: [so that you might share in the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ] or [in order that you might receive glory like our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 2:14 (#3)

εἰς περιποίησιν δόξης τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν

“to the acquiring of the glory of our Lord”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you can express the same idea with a different form. Alternate translation: [so that you might become glorious like our Lord]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:14 (#1)

διὰ τοῦ εὐαγγελίου ἡμῶν

“through our gospel”

Here, the phrase **through our gospel** does not mean that the gospel belongs to Paul and his companions. It refers to the gospel about Jesus that Paul and his companions preached. Alternate translation: [through the gospel that we preached to you]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#2)

ἀδελφοί

“brothers”

Here, **brothers** means fellow believers in Jesus, including both men and women. Alternate translation: [brothers and sisters]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#7)

διὰ λόγου

“by word”

Here, **by word** is an expression that means that Paul had been present with them and taught them personally. Alternate translation: [by what we said to you in person] or [when we were talking to you.]

See: Synecdoche

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#5)

στήκετε καὶ κρατεῖτε

"stand firm and hold tight to"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The repetition is used to emphasize the importance of doing this. If your language does not use repetition to do this, you can use one phrase and provide emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [keep on firmly believing] or [do not allow anyone to change your mind in any way about]

See: Doublet

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#6)

ἐδιδάχθητε

"you were taught"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can say this with an active form. Alternate translation: [we have taught you]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#8)

δι' ἐπιστολῆς ἡμῶν

"by our letter"

You can make clear the implicit information that **by our letter** refers to what Paul taught to the Thessalonians in an earlier letter (probably 1 Thessalonians). Alternate translation: [by what we wrote to you in a letter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#3)

στήκετε

"stand firm"

Here, the phrase **stand firm** is used to mean to not change one's beliefs but, rather, to remain steadfast in what one believes. If this would be unclear in your language, consider using an equivalent expression, or use plain language. Alternate translation: [continue to believe the truth] or [do not give up your faith]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#1)

ἄρα οὖν

"So then"

The words **So then** connect this verse with verses 13 and 14 as their logical conclusion. Because God did the wonderful things in those verses, the Thessalonians should do what verse 15 says. Use a natural way to introduce a conclusion in your language. Alternate translation: [Therefore] or [Because God did all of that for you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

2 Thessalonians 2:15 (#4)

κρατεῖτε τὰς παραδόσεις

"hold tight to the traditions"

Here, **traditions** refers to the truths about Christ that Paul and the other apostles taught. Paul speaks of them as if his readers could hold on to them with their hands. Alternate translation: [do not give up believing those truths] or [continue to believe the true teachings]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 2:16 (#3)

ἡμῶν & ἡμῶν & ἡμᾶς

"our & our & us"

The words **our** and **us** refer to all believers including the writers. If you have exclusive and inclusive first-person plural pronouns in your language, these should be inclusive pronouns.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

2 Thessalonians 2:16 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

The word translated **Now** marks a change in topic. You can use a natural way in your language to show that this is a new section with a different topic than the previous section.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Thessalonians 2:16 (#6)

ἐν χάριτι

"through grace"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because of how gracious he is to us]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:16 (#5)

δοὺς παράκλησιν αἰωνίαν, καὶ ἐλπίδα ἀγαθὴν

"gave {us} eternal comfort and good hope"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **comfort** and **hope**, you can express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [always comforts us and has given us good things to hope for]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 2:16 (#2)

αὐτὸς δὲ ὁ Κύριος ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦς Χριστὸς, καὶ ὁ Θεὸς ὁ Πατὴρ ἡμῶν

"Now our Lord Jesus Christ himself, and God our Father"

Connecting Statement:

Paul ends this section with a blessing. Use a form that people would recognize as a blessing in your language. Alternate translation: [Now may our Lord Jesus Christ himself, and God our Father] or [We pray that our Lord Jesus Christ himself, and God our Father]

See: Blessings

2 Thessalonians 2:16 (#4)

αὐτὸς & ὁ Κύριος ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦς Χριστὸς

"our Lord Jesus Christ himself"

Here, **himself** gives additional emphasis to the phrase **Lord Jesus Christ**. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [our Lord Jesus Christ, the very one]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

2 Thessalonians 2:17 (#1)

παρακαλέσαι ὑμῶν τὰς καρδίας, καὶ στηρίξαι

"may he comfort and strengthen your hearts"

Here, the word **hearts** represents both the emotion and will of a person. If **hearts** does not mean this in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [may he give comfort and strength to your livers] or [may he comfort you and strengthen you]

See: Metonymy

2 Thessalonians 2:17 (#2)

ἐν παντὶ ἔργῳ καὶ λόγῳ ἀγαθῷ

"in every good work and word"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the phrase **work and word** with verbs. Alternate translation: [in every good thing that you do and say] or [so that you could do and say everything that is good.]

See: Synecdoche

2 Thessalonians - Chapter 3 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Idle and lazy persons
In Thessalonica, there apparently was a problem with people in the church who were able to work but refused to do so. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

What should you do if your brother sins?
In this chapter, Paul teaches that Christians need to live in a way that honors God. Christians should also encourage one another and hold each other accountable for what they do. The church is also responsible for encouraging believers to repent if they sin. (See: repent, repentance; and sin, sinful, sinner, sinning)

2 Thessalonians 3:1 (#3)

ἀδελφοί

"brothers"

Here, **brothers** means fellow Christians, including both men and women. Alternate translation: [brothers and sisters]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 3:1 (#6)

καὶ δοξάζηται

"and might be glorified"

You can state this in active form, if the passive construction is not natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and that many people would honor it]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 3:1 (#4)

ἡμῶν

"us"

The pronoun **us** refers to Paul and his companions. If you have exclusive and inclusive first person pronouns in your language, this should be an exclusive pronoun.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

2 Thessalonians 3:1 (#2)

τὸ λοιπὸν

"Finally"

Here, the word **Finally** marks a change in topic. To **pray** is not the final instruction that Paul gives but it is how Paul opens the last section of his letter where he will discuss a few remaining matters. Alternate translation: [One more thing] or [So, continuing on]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Thessalonians 3:1 (#5)

τρέχῃ

"might run"

Paul speaks of God's **word** spreading as if it were running from place to place. He is comparing the rapid spread of God's word to a person who takes good news to others. Alternate translation: [might spread rapidly] or [might be heard by many people]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 3:1 (#7)

καθὼς καὶ πρὸς ὑμᾶς

"just as also with you"

This phrase leaves out some words that many languages might need to be complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [just as also happened with you] or [which is exactly what you did]

See: Ellipsis

2 Thessalonians 3:1 (#1)

In verses 1–5, Paul asks the believers to pray for him and his companions and encourages them. A heading for this section might be, "Pray for Us."

See: Section Headings

2 Thessalonians 3:2 (#3)

οὐ γὰρ πάντων ἡ πίστις

"for not everyone {has} the faith"

The phrase **not everyone** is a negative understatement that emphasizes how rare faith is. If this is confusing in your language, you can express the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [for only some people believe in the Lord] or [for people who believe in Jesus are few]

See: Litotes

2 Thessalonians 3:2 (#2)

ἀτόπων καὶ πονηρῶν

"perverse and evil"

The two terms **perverse** and **evil** mean basically the same thing and are used together to emphasize the amount of evil. If your language does not use repetition to do this or if you do not have two words for these attributes, you can use one phrase and provide emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [very wicked men] or [many wicked men]

See: Doublet

2 Thessalonians 3:2 (#4)

ἡ πίστις

"has} the faith"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [believes in Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 3:2 (#1)

ῥυσθῶμεν

"we might be rescued"

You can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God may save us] or [God may rescue us]

See: Active or Passive

2 Thessalonians 3:3 (#1)

ὃς στηρίξει

"who will strengthen"

The word **strengthen** here refers to spiritual strength, not physical strength. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [who will strengthen you spiritually] or [who will make you inwardly strong]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 3:3 (#2)

τοῦ πονηροῦ

"the evil one"

This could mean: (1) the evil being Satan. Alternate translation: [Satan] or (2) evil in general. Alternate translation: [evil]

2 Thessalonians 3:4 (#2)

πεποίθαμεν δὲ ἐν Κυρίῳ ἐφ' ὑμᾶς

"We are also confident in the Lord about you"

This could mean: (1) Paul has confidence in the Thessalonian believers because of the close relationship that they have with the Lord Jesus. In this case, Paul is speaking of this relationship as if they were inside the Lord Jesus. Alternate translation: [Because you are united to the Lord, we are also confident]; (2) Paul has confidence in the Lord Jesus, that he will cause them to do what is right. Alternate translation: [Because we trust in the Lord Jesus to enable you, we are also confident]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 3:4 (#1)

πεποίθαμεν δὲ

"We are also confident"

The phrase **We are also confident** may be confusing in some languages. If that is the case in your language, you could translate this as a noun phrase. Alternate translation: [We also have faith] or [We also trust]

See: Nominal Adjectives

2 Thessalonians 3:5 (#2)

εἰς τὴν ἀγάπην τοῦ Θεοῦ, καὶ εἰς τὴν ὑπομονὴν τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"to the love of God and to the endurance of Christ"

Paul speaks of God's **love** and Christ's **endurance** as if they were destinations on a path. If your readers would not understand this figure of speech, you could express the meaning in a nonfigurative way. Alternate translation: [to know how much God loves you and the endurance that Christ supplies you]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 3:5 (#3)

εἰς τὴν ἀγάπην τοῦ Θεοῦ, καὶ εἰς τὴν ὑπομονὴν τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"to the love of God and to the endurance of Christ"

Here, **love of God** can mean (1) the love that comes from God. Alternate translation: [to know how much God loves you] or (2) the love that people give to God. Alternate translation: [to love God more]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 3:5 (#1)

ὁ & Κύριος κατευθύναι ὑμῶν τὰς καρδίας εἰς τὴν ἀγάπην τοῦ Θεοῦ, καὶ εἰς τὴν ὑπομονὴν τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"may the Lord direct your hearts to the love of God and to the endurance of Christ"

Here, **hearts** stands for a person's thoughts or mind. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [may the Lord cause you to understand the love of God and the endurance of Christ] or [may the Lord help you to know the love of God and the endurance of Christ]

See: Metonymy

2 Thessalonians 3:5 (#4)

εἰς τὴν ὑπομονὴν τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"to the endurance of Christ"

Here, **endurance of Christ** can mean (1) the endurance that Christ gives to his people. Alternate translation: [to experience the endurance that Christ gives you] or (2) the endurance that Christ had through his suffering. Alternate translation: [to know how much Christ has endured for you]

See: Possession

2 Thessalonians 3:6 (#3)

ἀδελφοί & ἀδελφοῦ

"brothers & brother"

Here, the words **brothers** and **brother** refer to fellow Christians, including both men and women. Alternate translation: [brothers and sisters ... brother or sister]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 3:6 (#7)

τὴν παράδοσιν

"the traditions"

Here, **the traditions** refers to the teachings that the apostles received from Jesus and are passing along to

all believers. Alternate translation: [the teachings] or [the instructions]

2 Thessalonians 3:6 (#2)

δὲ

"Now"

The word translated **Now** marks a change in topic. You can use a natural way in your language to show that this is a new section with a different topic than the previous section.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Thessalonians 3:6 (#5)

ἡμῶν

"our"

Here, **our** refers to all believers. If you have exclusive and inclusive first-person plural pronouns in your language, this should be an inclusive pronoun.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

2 Thessalonians 3:6 (#6)

ἀτάκτως περιπατοῦντος

"walking disorderly"

Here Paul speaks of people who are not living well as if they walk in a haphazard manner. If your readers would not understand this metaphor, you could use an equivalent metaphor from your culture. Alternatively, you could express the meaning in a nonfigurative way. Alternate translation: [who is living in a bad way] or [who is not living correctly]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 3:6 (#1)

In verses 6–15, Paul gives the believers some final instructions about working and not being idle. A heading for this section might be, "Believers Must Work."

See: Section Headings

2 Thessalonians 3:6 (#4)

ἐν ὀνόματι τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ"

Here, **name** stands for the person of Jesus Christ. It can also mean "with the authority of." If using this term is not clear in your language, you could express it directly. Alternate translation: [as if our Lord Jesus Christ himself were speaking] or [with the authority that our Lord Jesus Christ has given us]

See: Metonymy

2 Thessalonians 3:7 (#1)

μιμεῖσθαι ἡμᾶς

"to imitate us"

The phrase **to imitate** may be a difficult word to translate in your language. In that case, you could make this explicit. Alternate translation: [to act the way that my fellow workers and I act]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 3:7 (#2)

οὐκ ἠτακτήσαμεν ἐν ὑμῖν

"we did not behave disorderly among you"

Paul uses a double negative to emphasize the positive. If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [we lived among you as those who had much discipline] or [we worked diligently when we were with you]

See: Double Negatives

2 Thessalonians 3:8 (#1)

ἄρτον

"bread"

Paul refers to **bread** here because it was the most common and basic food for them. If your readers would not be familiar with **bread** or if that is a kind of food that would be considered unusual or extravagant, you could use a general expression for ordinary food. Alternate translation: [food] or [anything]

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Thessalonians 3:8 (#3)

ἐν κόπῳ καὶ μόχθῳ

"in toil and hardship"

Here, **toil** and **hardship** have very similar meanings. Paul used this repetition to emphasize that they worked very hard. If you do not have two similar words that you can use here or if it would be unnatural for you to use such repetition, you could emphasize this in another way. Alternate translation: [with great effort] or [in very difficult circumstances]

See: Doublet

2 Thessalonians 3:8 (#2)

νυκτὸς καὶ ἡμέρας ἐργαζόμενοι

“working night and day”

Here, **night and day** forms a merism, which means “all the time.” If it would be helpful in your language to explain that they did not work without taking any rest whatsoever, then you could make the meaning clear. Alternate translation: [working throughout that time with little rest] or [we worked almost continuously]

See: Merism

2 Thessalonians 3:9 (#1)

οὐχ ὅτι οὐκ ἔχομεν ἐξουσίαν, ἀλλ’

“not because we do not have authority, but”

Paul uses a double negative to emphasize the positive. If this double negative would be misunderstood in your language, you could translate it as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [and we certainly have the right to receive food from you, but instead we worked for our food]

See: Double Negatives

2 Thessalonians 3:9 (#2)

ἑαυτοὺς τύπον δῶμεν ὑμῖν

“we might offer ourselves {as} an example to you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **example**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [we might show you the right way in order for you] or [we might demonstrate the way to live for you]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 3:9 (#3)

εἰς τὸ μιμεῖσθαι

“to imitate”

See how you translated **imitate** in verse 7.

2 Thessalonians 3:10 (#1)

εἴ τις οὐ θέλει ἐργάζεσθαι, μηδὲ ἐσθιέτω

“If anyone is not willing to work, do not even let him eat”

You can state this in positive form, if this form is difficult to understand in your language. Alternate translation: [If a person wants to eat, he must work]

See: Double Negatives

2 Thessalonians 3:11 (#2)

ἀλλὰ περιεργαζομένους

“but meddling”

Meddlers are people who interfere in the affairs of others without being asked to help.

See: Translate Unknowns

2 Thessalonians 3:11 (#1)

τινας περιπατοῦντας & ἀτάκτως

“some walking idly”

Here, **walking** stands for behavior in life. you can use an equivalent metaphor from your culture, if it is available. Otherwise, you could express the meaning in a nonfigurative way. Alternate translation: [some who are living idle lives] or [some who are being lazy]

See: Metaphor

2 Thessalonians 3:12 (#1)

μετὰ ἡσυχίας

“with quietness”

Here, **with quietness** is the opposite of meddling. Paul exhorts the meddlers to stop getting involved in other people’s affairs. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **quietness**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in a quiet and peaceful manner]

See: Abstract Nouns

2 Thessalonians 3:13 (#3)

ἀδελφοί

“brothers”

Here, **brothers** means fellow Christians, including both men and women. Alternate translation: [brothers and sisters]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 3:13 (#1)

δέ

“But”

Paul here uses the word **But** to contrast the lazy believers with the hardworking believers. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a contrast. Alternate translation: [Concerning]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

2 Thessalonians 3:13 (#2)

ὑμεῖς

“you”

The word **you** refers to all the Thessalonian believers, so it should be in plural form.

See: Forms of You

2 Thessalonians 3:14 (#1)

τῷ λόγῳ ἡμῶν

“our word”

Paul is referring to his command to the Thessalonian believers as a **word**. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [our instructions]

See: Metonymy

2 Thessalonians 3:14 (#3)

ἵνα ἐντραπῇ

“so that he may be put to shame”

Paul instructs believers to avoid lazy believers as a disciplinary action. If necessary, you could make this explicit to make the meaning clear. Alternate translation: [in order that he will know that his laziness is wrong]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 3:14 (#2)

τοῦτον σημειοῦσθε

“note this one”

Paul wants the Thessalonians to notice who this person is. Alternate translation: [point out that person] or [make sure everyone knows who he is]

See: Idiom

2 Thessalonians 3:15 (#1)

ἀδελφόν

“a brother”

Although the term **brother** is masculine, Paul is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [a fellow believer]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

2 Thessalonians 3:16 (#3)

αὐτὸς & ὁ Κύριος τῆς εἰρήνης, δῴη ὑμῖν

“may the Lord of peace himself give you”

Paul ends the letter with blessings that are also prayers. Use a form that people would recognize as a blessing or prayer in your language. Alternate translation: [I pray that the Lord of peace himself may give you]

See: Blessings

2 Thessalonians 3:16 (#2)

δὲ

“Now”

The word translated **Now** marks a change in topic. You can use a natural way in your language to show that this is a new section with a different topic than the previous section.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

2 Thessalonians 3:16 (#4)

αὐτὸς & ὁ Κύριος τῆς εἰρήνης

“the Lord of peace himself”

Here, **himself** emphasizes that the Lord is the source of peace and that he will personally give peace to believers.

See: Reflexive Pronouns

2 Thessalonians 3:16 (#1)

In verses 16–18, Paul makes closing remarks to the believers at Thessalonica. A heading for this section might be, “Closing Remarks.”

See: Section Headings

2 Thessalonians 3:17 (#1)

ὁ ἀσπασμὸς τῇ ἐμῇ χειρὶ, Παύλου, ὅ ἐστιν σημεῖον ἐν πάσῃ ἐπιστολῇ, οὕτως γράφω

“This greeting {is} in my own hand—Paul—which is a sign in every letter. In this manner I write”

Alternate translation: [I, Paul, write this greeting with my own hand, which I do in every letter, as a sign that this letter is truly from me because this is how I write]

2 Thessalonians 3:17 (#2)

τῇ ἐμῇ χειρὶ

“is} in my own hand”

Here, the phrase **in my own hand** is an idiom meaning "in my own handwriting." If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [I myself am writing]

See: Idiom

2 Thessalonians 3:17 (#3)

οὕτως γράφω

"In this manner I write"

Paul makes it clear that this letter is from him and is not a forgery. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express that explicitly. Alternate translation: [you could know that the letter is from me because this is how I write]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

2 Thessalonians 3:18 (#1)

ἡ χάρις τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, μετὰ πάντων ὑμῶν

"The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ {be} with you all"

Paul ends the letter with one more blessing. Use a form that people would recognize as a blessing in your language. Alternate translation: [I pray that the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ will be with you all]

See: Blessings